

ally looking at the screen (though it is almost equally impossible to type on full QWERTY keypads on most smartphones without looking at the phone too). This is a hit-or-miss idea. It has the potential to be a total hit if the screen works as flawlessly as promised, but it also has the potential to be a severe roadblock for the phone. Touchscreen phones have never been a hit with the SMS junkies of the world, and much as Apple would like to change that, it has a strong potential to backfire.

Additional software:

Jobs, when asked about whether the iPhone would allow third-party software, said that though Apple would be releasing new applications for the iPhone, it won't allow unrestricted third-party software like on PCs or Macs. "We define everything that is on the phone. You don't want your phone to be like a PC. The last thing you want is to have loaded three apps on your phone and then you go to make a call and it doesn't work anymore. These are more like iPods than they are like computers." Sounds pretty dismal... It does get better though: "These are devices that need to work, and you can't do that if you load any software on them. That doesn't mean there's not going to be software to buy that you can load on them coming from us. It doesn't mean we have to write it all, but it means it has to be more of a controlled environment." We've quoted this because it is not very clear what will be the process of installing software onto the iPhone at this point.

Windows Compatibility

It is a given that the iPhone will connect and synchronise flawlessly with Macs, but the extent of compatibility with Windows through iTunes remains under a shadow of doubt. The iPhone is supposed to synchronise all your contacts, calendars, photos, notes, bookmarks and e-mail accounts from both Macs and Windows through iTunes. This means that the next version of iTunes will have such functionality built into it so that it can connect and synchronise with the Address Book, iCal, iPhoto, Safari, and Mail applications on a Mac. But will it be just as efficient on a Windows PC? Will it be able to flawlessly integrate with the